

Council Meeting

June 28, 2023

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Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, June 28, 2023, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Spencer Batchelder
At-Large Councilor Matthew Mooshian
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Girard removed Resolution 2023-35 ARC and Wheelhouse Agreement to the first meeting in July.

Councilor Stone asked to move item Resolution 2024-6 to large letter E. (a.) under New Business.

By consensus Council agreed to move the item.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept the minutes of the June 14, 2023, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

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Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Girard asked for a moment of silence for the passing of former Welfare Director Joan Coolidge.

Mayor Girard gave a reminder for the Fourth of July celebration being held from 6:30 p.m.- 9:30 p.m. at Monadnock Park, where the fireworks will start around 930, and noted the rain date is July 5th.

July 8th and 9th Arrowhead will be hosting a 2023 enduro series bike event.

The next Second Saturday Event will be held Saturday July 8th from 4pm-8pm on Pleasant Street, the theme is heritage and history.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

City Manager Manale shared DPW will be starting their residential water shut offs for non-payments. Business and rental shut offs are tentatively scheduled for July 12th.

DPW is set to start this year's sidewalk replacement program beginning July 5th on Maple Ave.

Volunteers from the Sullivan House helped clean up North and Main Street filling ten trash bags, and scrap metal.

July 1st at noon, there will be a speech held at the Broad Street bandstand there will be a reading of Fredrick Douglass' famous speech "What to the Slave is the Fourth of July"

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard reminded all that citizens forum is for non-agenda items, and is limited to five minutes.

No one spoke, Mayor Girard closed the public forum.

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OLD BUSINESS

Municipal Complex (Maintenance)

Director Mulholland explained adding another position into this budget, and shared the Council had asked for a reduction in the current cleaning contract. Director Mulholland noted subtracting \$27,920.00 would be that reduction, bringing the total budget to \$653,236.00.

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to tentatively approve the Municipal Complex Budget for \$653,236.00.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – no

Batchelder - yes

Stone - no

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Limoges – no

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - no

Motion failed 6-3

Councilor Stone asked if this was the right time to be adding positions into the budget.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to tentatively approve the Municipal Complex Budget for \$603,058.00.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Limoges – yes

Contois - no

Mooshian - no

Girard - yes

Motion carried 6-3

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General Fund Revenue

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to Tentatively approve the General Fund Revenue budget for \$7,191,189.00.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Sewer Fund Budget

Director Gleeson presented the Sewer Fund Budget, and noted previous changes such as adding half of the Assistant Director pay, and adding a truck driver that wasn’t captured.

Director Gleeson stated the Solar Array revenue estimate is \$6,400.00.

The Sewer entrance fee has a \$100.00 place holder for a permit.

The Capacity fee revenue payments for sewer; the number is now reflected as \$22,468.00 vs. 0 with a table below for the Dialysis Center, Monadnock Mills, and the car wash.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by O’Hearne to Tentatively Approve the Sewer fund budget for 2,928,151.00.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

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Roads and Streets

Director Gleeson presented the Roads and Streets Budget. Director Gleeson noted the elimination of a laborer, and adding money to the overtime.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to tentatively approve the roads and streets budget for 3,782,443.00.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian –

Contois - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2023-33 Sewer Loan Amendment

Kristen Lemansy from Wright Pierce Engineering joined the Council meeting via zoom to explain the loan amendment for Resolution 2023-33.

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept resolution 2023-33.

Councilor Batchelder read resolution 2023-33 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

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Limoges - yes

Mooshian –

Contois - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2023-34 Donation to CPD

Police Chief Wilmont, welcomed Christian Gomes, the owner of Ford of Claremont, and asked the Council to accept his donation of a Ford Lightning to the City for the Claremont Police Department. Chief Wilmot noted

this will be the fourth vehicle donated by them. Chief Wilmot was confident that the installation of the charger and lettering of the vehicle could be absorbed into the FY23 budget.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept Resolution 2023-34.

Councilor Limoges read Resolution 2023-34 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing.

Elizabeth Cram, Ward 1, stated the truck was a great gift to give to the City. Ms. Cram shared concern about the way Mr. Gomes spoke to the Council a few months ago and wonders if there will be an expectation for a return on the donation.

Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian –

Contois - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Ordinance 608 Food Truck Policy – First Reading

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Councilor Stone stated due diligence has been done for the mobile food unit, and hoping it satisfies everyone's needs.

Manager Manale pointed out there were a few redline changes that were not added to the Ordinance, such as location and hours.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to pass this to a second reading on July 12th with amendments.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O'Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian – yes

Contois - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

FY2024 – Public Hearing and Vote

Resolution 2024-6 To Adopt the Capital Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

Manager Manale presented Resolution 2024-6 and noted this budget has been tentatively approved and includes a bond for a 3-year paving plan, a transfer from the general fund, and multiple capital investments projects throughout City.

Councilor Stone expressed concern in past for bonding, and stated he does not support bonding.

Councilor Koloski also shared concern for bonding.

Councilor Batchelder asked if the bond will outlive life of the road, Manager Manale responded by stating no, and that it is a ten-year bond and explained how the City has not invested in infrastructure in a long time, while noting there is a plan for Washington Street being repaired by mostly state funds.

Assistant Mayor Matteau expressed not liking to borrow or bond, but stated there is a bond retiring and the rate is very favorable to the City. Assistant Mayor Matteau noted the need to fix roads, and how if it doesn't get done now, it will only get worse while also expressing what can be bought today will probably be half in five years and doesn't think side streets should be ignored.

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A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Limoges to remove bonding from the Capital Budget.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Limoges – yes

Contois - no

Mooshian - no

Girard - yes

Motion carried 5-4

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adopt the Capital budget Resolution 2024-6 with the removal of bonding for a total of \$657,000.00

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Limoges – yes

Contois - no

Mooshian - no

Girard - yes

Motion carried 5-4

Resolution 2024-1 Tax Anticipation Note – Public Hearing

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to adopt resolution 2024-1.

Assistant Mayor Matteau read Resolution 2024-1 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened up public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

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Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian – yes

Contois - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Mayor Girard stated there was not a public hearing for Resolution 2024-6 and will need to reconsider.

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to reconsider Resolution 2024-6 Capital Budget.

Voice Vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Mooshian –

Contois - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Batchelder and seconded by Councilor Stone to adopt Resolution 2024-6.

Councilor Batchelder read Resolution 2024-6 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing.

Walt Stapelton, Ward 3, State Representative for Sullivan County District 6, expressed interest in the bonding discussion and stated kicking the can down the road is never a good idea. Federal funds are only going to go up and abandoning the bond was not a good move. Mr. Stapelton stated the time to do the work is now.

Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

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Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - no

Koloski - no

Limoges – yes

Contois - no

Mooshian - no

Girard - yes

Motion carried 5-4

Resolution 2024-2 To Adopt the 2024 General Fund Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to remove \$20,000.00 from the airport budget.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Contois - no

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-1

Councilor Stone expressed concern for the DPW vehicle wraps.

Director Gleeson stated the issue is getting trucks in that specific green color, so wrapping would be easier however more expensive, and would like to go to a standard color.

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to rescind a previous Council motion to make the DPW truck color FEMA green.

Voice Vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

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Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Councilor O’Hearne expressed concern for having the same color as the fire department, and stated colors should be separate from other departments.

Mayor Girard suggested the director to come up with a color plan.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to make DPW trucks red.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Councilor Stone suggested removing \$50,000.00 from the CSBCC Budget.

Director Lawrence shared that he was not in favor of this and looking at the budget, the only room would be in part-time, however the CSBCC is severely understaffed this year, and stated the need for more support for the center.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Stone to adopt Resolution 2024-2 with the Airport amendment.

Councilor Limoges read resolution 2024-2 into record.

Councilor Koloski wants to see more money in streets and roads without a bond, Assistant Mayor Matteau agrees and shared concern for inflation and suggested adding \$250,000.00 into paving.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to add \$250,000.00 into paving.

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Roll call:

O’Hearne – no

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 8-1

Roll call

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing.

Walt Stapleton, Ward 3, shared he was glad about the added the \$250,000.00 to paving but feels like council should have cut the \$50,000.00 from the CSB.

Mayor Girard Closed the public hearing

Resolution 2024-3 To Adopt the 2024 Water Division Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor to adopt Resolution 2024-3.

Assistant Mayor Matteau read resolution 2024-3 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

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Roll call

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2024-4 To Adopt the 2024 Sewer Division Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Mattea to adopt Resolution 2024-4.

Councilor Koloski read Resolution 2024-4 into record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2024-5 To Adopt the 2024 Downtown Tax Increment Finance District Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

A motion was made by Councilor Contois and seconded by Councilor Koloski to adopt Resolution 2024-5.

Councilor Contois read resolution 2024-5 into the record.

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Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges - yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

None.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Limoges asked for an update on internet expansion.

Manager Manale responded that Comcast is waiting for state money to expand high speed internet on more streets.

Councilor Koloski noted there is a tree in Broad Street Park that is severely damaged. Manager Manale is working with Parks and an arborist.

Councilor Stone asked about the tax deeding list, and public auction. Manager Manale noted there is an auction in August.

Councilor Stone noted the Police commission doesn’t have emails posted on the City website.

Council shared concern for the new email program, Manager Manale suggested IT come to the next meeting.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

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At 9:27p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Batchelder to adjourn.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Batchelder - yes

Stone - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Limoges – yes

Contois - yes

Mooshian - yes

Girard - yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro

Clerk to the Council